

In a nutshell, Emby can be used to centralise all media content, manage its metadata and artwork, access content on a multitude of different devices, share content with family and friends, and more.

Technical features

- Easy GUI for accessing personal media files, Live TV streaming, DVR management and recordings management.
- Easy sync with smartphones, tablets and even the cloud.
- Detects DLNA (Digital Living Network Alliance) devices for easy content access and supports Chromecast for streaming.
- Web based tools for editing metadata and subtitles, along with comprehensive parental controls.

Latest version: 3.5.0.0

Official website: <https://emby.media>

4. MediaPortal

MediaPortal is an open source media server player-cum-digital video recorder with an interface and features similar to Kodi. It uses the '10-foot UI' for all media functionalities like playing, pause, recording and other utilities.

MediaPortal also allows you to record, watch and timeshift Live TV, record video, listen to your favourite radio stations (local radio stations using the FM tuner of your capture card), and play any movie your PC has a codec for (DivX, MPEG or Matroska). All your movies will be stored in Media Portal's video database. It includes support for multiple tuners and an advanced TV Guide based on XMLTV.

It was primarily designed for the Windows OS and the source code was mainly taken from XBMC (Kodi).

Technical features

- Live or recorded TV can be watched on network PCs.
- Supports browsing of all movies, videos and DVDs with posters, other details and even subtitles.
- Supports streaming of Live M, Web Radio and even additional radio stations via satellite cable provider.
- RSS reader and live weather feeds.
- Innumerable additional plugins and supports many



Figure 4: MediaPortal GUI

devices for live access.

Latest version: 2.2

Official website: <https://www.team-mediaportal.com/>

5. OpenELEC

OpenELEC (Open Embedded Linux Entertainment Centre) is an open source, powerful Linux-based embedded operating system specifically designed to run Kodi. It is based on JeOS (just enough operating system). The idea behind OpenELEC is to allow people to use their home theatre PC (HTPC) like any other device that one might have attached to a TV, such as a DVD player or Sky box. Instead of having to manage a full operating system, one can configure OpenELEC and install the packages required to turn it into a hybrid media centre. OpenELEC is designed to be simple to install, manage and use, making it more like running a set-top box than a full-blown computer.

OpenELEC has a comprehensive media centre software suite that comes with Kodi pre-configured and third-party add-ons, with retro video game console emulators and DVR plugins.

OpenELEC is an extremely small and very fast-booting Linux based distribution, primarily designed to boot from a Flash memory card such as CompactFlash or a solid-state drive, similar to that of the XBMCbuntu.



Figure 5: OpenELEC GUI

Technical features

- Powerful and simple organisation of movies. It supports the display of movie information, subtitles and fan art.
- Viewers can browse, watch and record all TV channels, manage TV series and track favourite TV shows.
- Offers support for lots of add-ons and plugins to enhance productivity and the user's multimedia experience.
- Supports many graphics units, and even Raspberry Pi and Apple TV.

Latest version: 8.0.4

Official website: <https://openelec.tv/>

6. OpenFLIXR

OpenFLIXR media server is an open source, virtual, flexible, energy-efficient and feature-packed all-in-one media server for automated downloading and the serving of media.